

Spiral

Technical Design Brief

Deckbuilding Roguelike | Roblox | Luau | Playable Prototype

This project is a playable deckbuilding roguelike prototype developed in Roblox using Luau. The current version recreates core systems from *Slay the Spire 2*, including turn-based card combat, branching map progression, multiple room types, deck building, rewards, and persistent run progression.

The purpose of the current prototype is to establish a working foundation to build on using new game ideas and mechanics.

Current Prototype

- Hero selection
- Branching map progression
- Turn-based card combat
- Draw and discard pile management
- Multiple enemy encounter pools
- Events, elites, campfires, treasure rooms, shops, and bosses
- Card rewards and deck progression
- Persistent health and deck state

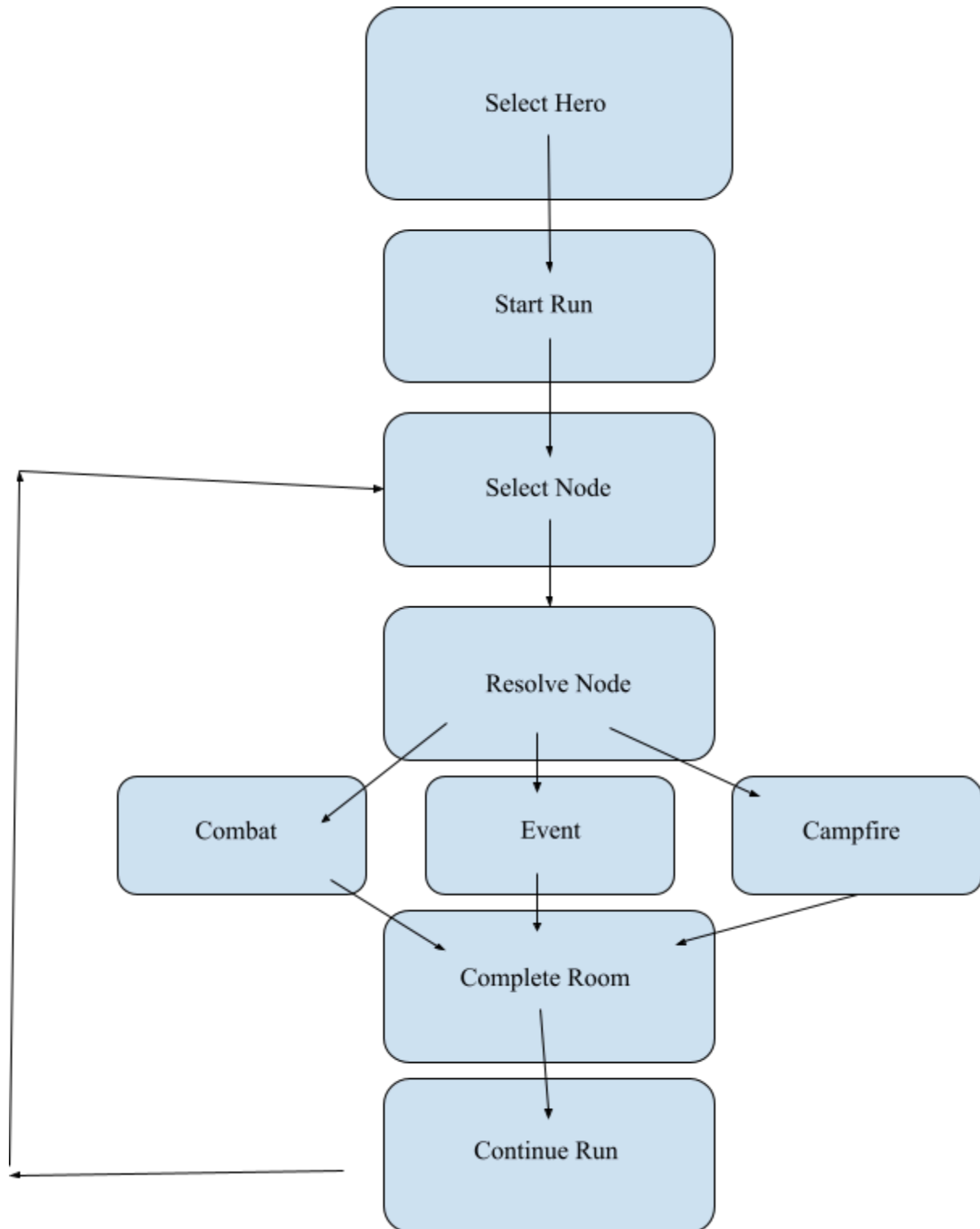
Project Goals

- Finish recreating STS2 entirely
- Develop experience managing a larger, multi-system codebase
- Create a playable foundation for experimenting with original mechanics
- Practice designing systems that can be expanded as development continues

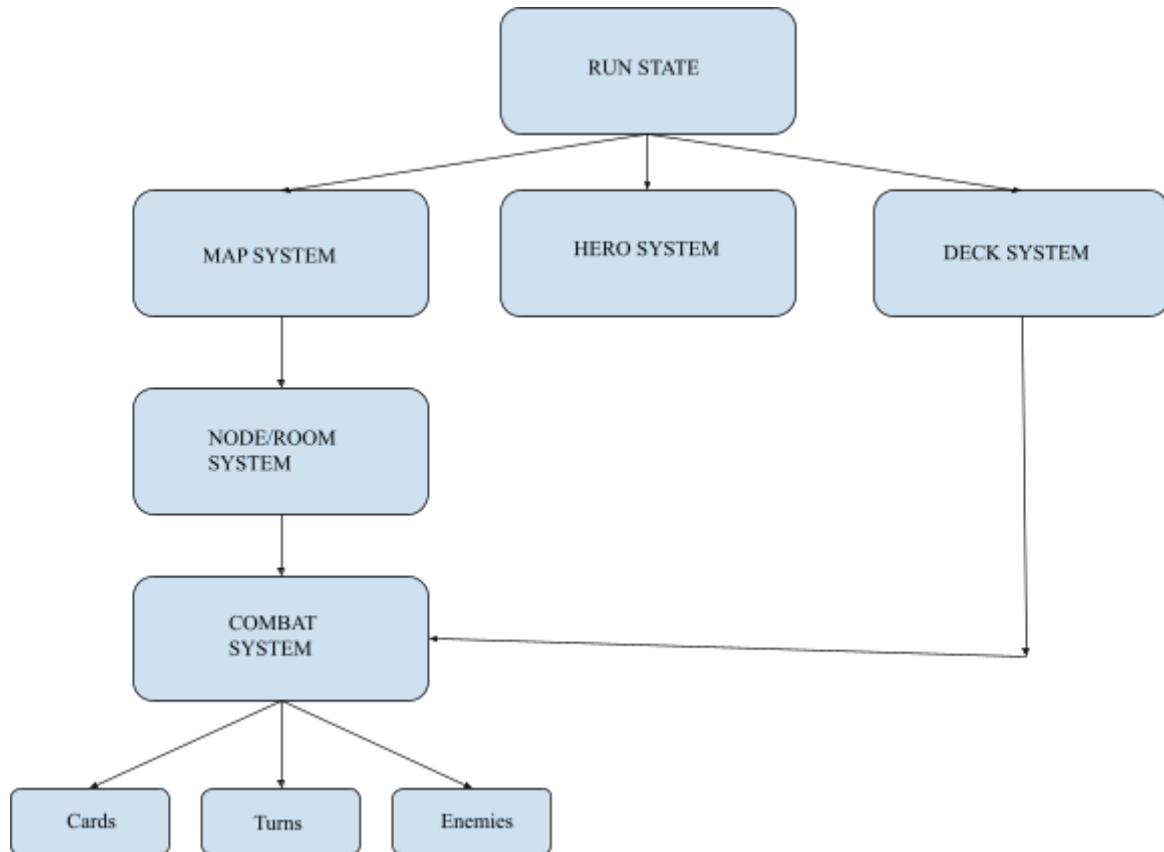
Project Scope

<u>Current Prototype</u>	<u>Future Development</u>
STS2 foundation	Original mechanics
Run progression	Reactive world
Card combat	Double-sided cards
Room types	Terrain
Encounter Pools	Additional modes

Core Gameplay Flow



System Architecture



This diagram shows how the major gameplay systems interact with each other. It focuses on the overall structure of the game.

Run State: acts as the shared state of the current run. It stores information that needs to remain consistent as the player moves between different parts of the game, such as the selected hero, current health, deck, and progression through the map.

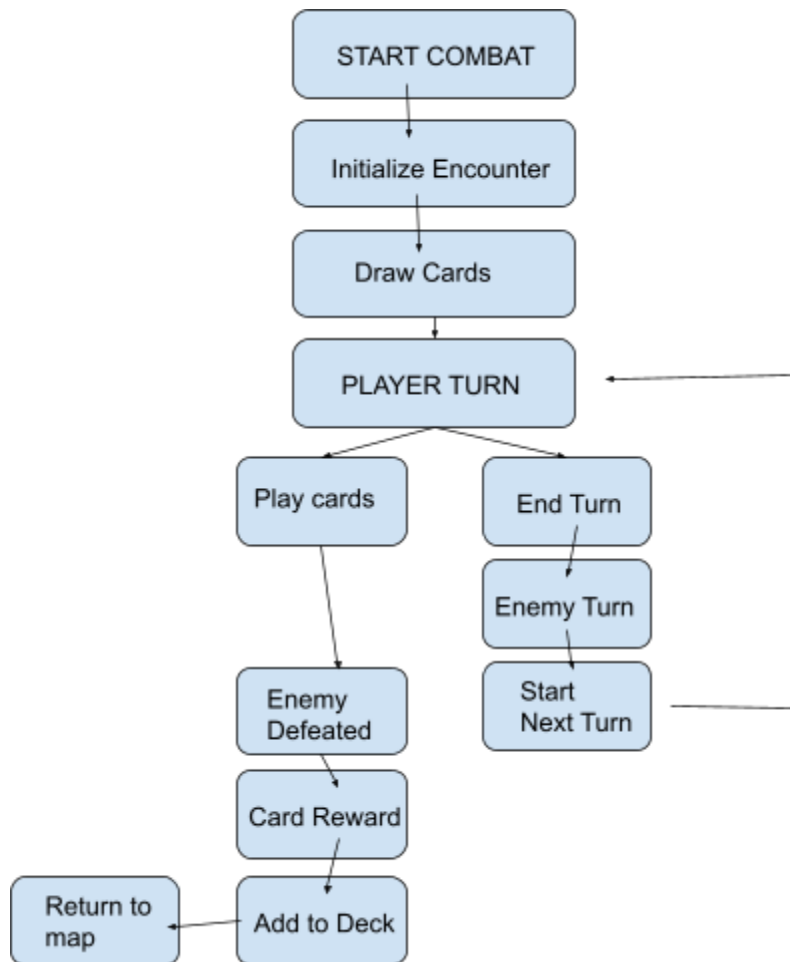
Map System: controls the player's progression through the run and allows the player to select available nodes. Once a node is selected, the **Node/Room System** determines what type of room should be loaded, such as a normal encounter, elite encounter, event, campfire, treasure room, shop, or boss.

Combat System: manages the active encounter. Combat connects several smaller systems, including card handling, player and enemy turns, enemy behavior, and win or loss conditions.

Deck System: provides the cards available to the player and manages changes to the deck that persist throughout the run.

Hero System: determines the character selected at the beginning of the run and provides the starting information needed by the other gameplay systems.

Combat Flow



Player Turn

During the player's turn, cards can be selected and played from the current hand. The player can also inspect the draw and discard piles before deciding which cards to use. The turn continues until the player chooses to end it.

Enemy Turn

After the player ends their turn, control passes to the enemy. The enemy performs its planned action before the game begins the next player turn.

Encounter Completion

When the enemy is defeated, combat ends and the player is presented with a card reward. The selected card is added to the player's deck and remains available for future encounters before the player returns to the map.

Planned Original Systems

The current prototype establishes the core gameplay foundation needed to begin developing systems that differentiate *Spiral* from its *Slay the Spire 2* inspiration. The following mechanics are planned or being explored for future development.

Reactive World

Decisions made during a run will be able to affect later events and situations. Rather than every event existing independently, player choices can change what becomes available or what happens later in the run.

Double-Sided Cards

Certain cards will have two sides with different effects. Players will be able to flip these cards to access their alternate effect, creating additional decisions around how and when a card should be used.

Battlefield Terrain

Card effects will be able to alter the battlefield itself. Different terrain states may interact with cards, enemies, or other combat mechanics, allowing the battlefield to become part of the player's strategy.

Experimental Dice Mechanics

A dice system is currently being considered as an additional layer of card interaction. Possible implementations include dice being used to play certain cards or cards that manipulate dice rolls. This mechanic is still experimental and may be changed or removed.

Alternate Game Modes

Additional game modes are planned that reuse the game's existing systems with different objectives or restrictions. Current ideas include **Boss Chase**, **Speedrun**, and **No-Hit** modes.

Development Status

Current: Playable STS2-inspired prototype